

Indian Railways goes green

The Indian Railways is replacing all bulbs in the Railway Quarters across the country with CFLs, earning credits in the process

58%

That's the amount by which India's emissions have increased in the last 10 years

used for appliances such as water heaters. As far as technology is concerned, the easiest way to calculate the carbon footprint is to measure the amount of electricity being consumed per month. This can be done by consulting the electricity bill, to calculate the amount of KiloWatt-hours (kWh) used every month. A typical four family household uses between 300 to 500 kWh every month. This can be converted into CO₂ emissions based on the methods used to generate the electricity that is consumed.

Here is a simple table based on different usage scenarios:

Device	Monthly usage	CO ₂ over 5 yrs	Number of trees
PC (CRT)	50 kWh	1.2 Tonnes	40/20 – 8/4 hours a day
PC (LCD)	37 kWh	0.6 Tonnes	20/10 – 8/4 hours a day
Laptop	12 kWh	0.3 Tonnes	10/5 – 8/4 hours a day
Netbook	8 kWh	0.2 Tonnes	8/4 – 8/4 hours a day
Mid sized Plasma TV	33 kWh	0.6 Tonnes	20/10 – 5/2.5 hours a day
Mid sized LCD TV	42 kWh	0.6 Tonnes	20/10 – 5/2.5 hours a day
Set top box	7 kWh	0.2 Tonnes	8/4 – 5/2.5 hours a day
PS3	30 kWh	0.5 Tonnes	20/10 – 5/2.5 hours a day
XBOX	29 kWh	0.5 Tonnes	20/10 – 5/2.5 hours a day
Wii	2.8 kWh	0.01 Tonnes	1/0 – 5/2.5 hours a day

CO₂ from the atmosphere. However, you would need five of these trees to grow for twenty five years before a tonne of CO₂ can be consumed. Initially, the capacity for CO₂ consumption is very low, but this increases over time and the growth of the tree. If the tree lasts for fifty years or more, it can eat up tonnes of CO₂. At the top-right of this page is a ready

reckoner for common gadgets, how much electricity they consume per month, and how many trees you need to plant to offset the use for a span of five years.

The Digit Trees

The Digit Trees are among the few trees that grow into full-sized trees from small seeds. There are two kinds of seeds included in the packaging, they are the Jacaranda and the Cassia Siamea. The pretty Jacaranda tree is best known for its bluish purplish flowers, while the Cassia Siamea is known for its fast growth, and the height, as these trees can easily grow to 30 feet in height. Both trees are easy to plant, and will take root in almost any kind of soil.

- 100 kWh/month : 0.04 carbon credits
- 200 kWh/month : 0.08 carbon credits
- 300 kWh/month : 0.13 carbon credits
- 500 kWh/month : 0.21 carbon credits
- 600 kWh/month : 0.25 carbon credits
- 800 kWh/month : 0.34 carbon credits
- 1000 kWh/month : 0.42 carbon credits
- 1200 kWh/month : 0.50 carbon credits
- 1500 kWh/month : 0.63 carbon credits
- 2000 kWh/month : 0.84 carbon credits

There are many ways to offset this carbon footprint. You can buy carbon credits directly using web services, or you can pay agencies to plant trees for you. A direct approach would be to use the seeds we have provided in this issue, and plant them. As part of our plan of making our surroundings greener, we've bundled a few seeds of the Jacaranda and Cassia Siamea trees in our packaging.

These trees are pretty fast growing, and can grow in many kinds of soil conditions. They are ideal trees for eating up

After you sow the seeds included in the Digit Package, register on Nokia's **PlanetKeRakhwale.com/treeplantation** to earn 250 Green Points. As your tree grows, you can come back to gain more points. You can redeem these points for a Green Guide, comic books, eco-friendly pen, Digit Fast Tracks, a green USB and much more at PlanetKeRakhwale.com. You can start redeem these prizes immediately. Also remember to join us on **www.facebook.com/ithinkgreen** to know how to keep adding points to your account, and redeem the products of your choice.

Remember the basics

Technology is inherently at odds with nature, in its current form. It does not need to be like that though, and experts around the world are working on new and innovative ways to create sustainable, cheap and useful technology that can easily reach the entire population of the planet. Despite all the pro-active steps that you might take, there are some elementary principles that still apply to making technology use greener. The 3Rs, Recycle, Re-use and Reduce is a good cornerstone for making sure that you have an essentially green lifestyle. With short shelf lives for most products, and short life cycles as well, most technology products are outdated in a few years. Even if there is a better version of a gadget out there, you do not need to lust after it. There is no shame in using an outdated PMP or an older camera model. At the end of the day, technology is just a tool, a means for achieving a particular end, it is best not to be caught up and mesmerized by the latest developments. Instead, it's just simply greener, and 1337er to boot, to find out new, creative ways to use the older gadgets. Spread the word, use every approach you can, and you can really make a difference. **td**

How to plant the Digit Tree

- 1 Take a cup measuring about 2-inches in depth and 4 inches in diameter.
- 2 Put some soft soil in it, but avoid sand.
- 3 Plant a few seeds about 1 cm below the surface.
- 4 Water the seeds once daily for a week. Pour sufficient water to keep the soil damp.
- 5 Keep the cup next to a window sill with decent amount of sunlight. Avoid keeping it under the sun all day.
- 6 The saplings should sprout in a week or two.
- 7 Transplant the saplings to a garden and continue watering.